

ENGLISH 2011

Questions 1 to 15

Read the passage below. It contains blank spaces numbered 1 to 15, for each blank space, choose the best alternative from the choices given.

It is often ___1___ that all living things, plants and animals, have a ___2___ for existence. Each living organism plays an important role ___3___ it exists. However, there is one creature whose importance is ___4___ to see. This is the mosquito. What most people know ___5___ this tiny beast is that it is the major ___6___ by which malaria is spread. It is therefore not ___7___ that some people have demanded the complete elimination of ___8___ species from the face of the earth.

It is interesting to note that the insect does not ___9___ to spread disease. It just wants to feed itself and to reproduce. Researchers have discovered the female mosquito needs to feed on the blood in order to lay eggs. As it moves from one source to another in ___10___ of blood, it ends up picking up and spreading the organisms that caused the disease. A common rule of nature is ___11___ at work here. The survival of one creature means the death of another.

Some scientists have argued that the insect is not ___12___ useless. It serves as food for some other creatures such as lizards, geckos and birds. The lives of these predators ___13___ be at risk if there were no mosquitoes, and this would ___14___ affect the population of animals that in turn feed on the predators. All this would finally affect the food chain, causing an imbalance ___15___ nature.

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|--------|----------|---------------|----------------|---------------|
| 1. A. | seen | B. felt | C. thought | D. said |
| 2. A. | part | B. reason | C. caused | D. purpose |
| 3. A. | whenever | B. where | C. wherever | D. when |
| 4. A. | hard | B. impossible | C. easy | D. clear |
| 5. A. | with | B. on | C. of | D. about |
| 6. A. | way | B. means | C. style | D. method |
| 7. A. | shocking | B. surprising | C. astonishing | D. amazing |
| 8. A. | that | B. those | C. this | D. these |
| 9. A. | set off | B. set about | C. set out | D. set fourth |
| 10. A. | search | B. need | C. hunt | D. chase |
| 11. A. | seen | B. found | C. noticed | D. observed |
| 12. A. | actually | B. fully | C. extremely | D. completely |
| 13. A. | would | B. must | C. will | D. may |
| 14. A. | lastly | B. eventually | C. furthermore | D. there fore |
| 15. A. | for | B. on | C. in | D. against |

For questions 16 and 17 select the alternative that best fills the blank space in the sentence below.

16. They had just finished reading the story _____
 A. Had they
 B. Did they
 C. Hadn't they
 D. Didn't they
17. She often sings in the choir, _____?
 A. Isn't it
 B. Doesn't it
 C. Does she
 D. Is it

For questions 18 to 20 choose the alternative that can best replace the underlined phrase

18. The little boy decided he would no longer put up with the bullying
 A. Accept
 B. Receive
 C. Take
 D. Tolerate
19. Tomno had not made up his mind where he would spend his holidays
 A. Decided
 B. Planted
 C. Said
 D. Imagined
20. She complained that most of her classmates looked down on her.
 A. Rejected
 B. Despised
 C. Abused
 D. Hated

In the questions 21 and 22 choose the alternative that is correctly punctuated

21. A. "Juma, the teacher asked, where have you been yesterday?"

- B. "Juma?" the teacher asked, where have you been since yesterday."
 C. "Juma," the teacher asked, "Where have you been since yesterday?"
 D. "Juma, the teacher asked where have you been since yesterday?"

22. A. The doctor said, "keep medicine out of children's reach."
 B. The doctor said, keep medicine out of children' reach
 C. The doctor said "keep medicine out of children' reach."
 D. The doctor said "Keep medicine out of children's reach."

For the questions 23 to 25, choose the alternative that means the opposite of the underlined word.

23. When I asked him why he had arrived late, I found his answer unsatisfactory.
 A. Sensible
 B. Reasonable
 C. Incorrect
 D. Unacceptable
24. It is risky to cross that bridge at night.
 A. Safe
 B. Dangerous
 C. Harmful
 D. Secure
25. The head teacher forbade the pupils to bring cooked food into school compound.
 A. Told
 B. Encouraged
 C. Allowed
 D. Advise

Read the passage below and then answer questions 26 to 38

“I wonder what Aoko is doing at home,” Jeri said, looking at her friend Cherono. “Why don’t we go and find out?”

The three close friends, in fact inseparable. They spent most of the day together, especially during the school holidays like now. Nine o’clock always found the girls together, and they would not part till evening. Strangely today, Aoko’s was nowhere to be seen yet it was already 10 o’clock.

The two girls walked to Aoko’s home. As they neared the house, Njeri called out, “Aoko, you have visitors!” there was no response. Obviously, their friend was not in.

Outside the house was seated an old lady the two girls and never seen before. They went up to her and Cherono greeted her in Aoko’s mother tongue. Cherono spoke the language fluently, one could not tell she was from a different community. The old lady responded and smiled broadly, exposing toothless gums. Njeri guessed the old lady was probably a hundred years old. Cherono then asked her where Aoko was.

I sent her to the shops to buy something, just get in and wait. I’m sure she’s on her way back, said the lady.

Njeri did not understand a word. She just followed her friend into the house

Half an hour later, the girls were still waiting. Impatience got the better of Njeri. She suggested that they go away and return later. Cherono on the other hand had a different idea. She was curious about the old lady seated outside.

“Why don’t we go out and chat with the lady, you know these old people usually have fascinating stories to tell,” she said.

“But I won’t understand a thing for you, the language is not a problem, so you’ll probably enjoy the stories,” grumbled Njeri.

After a little persuasion, Njeri gave in the condition that Cherono would translate everything into English or Kiswahili. They went out and found the lady humming a tune. She was in the world of her own, her face a picture of happiness. She did not seem to notice the two girls, who also did not want to break in on her bliss.

“Oh!” she exclaimed when she realized she was being watched “I really love singing. It is good for the soul. Do you also sing?” she said.

Njeri looked at Cherono expecting her to translate what the lady had just said. And she said did.

“I see your friend does not understand our language. The lady communicated in English. The two girls were taken aback. “I just wanted to find out whether you two also love to sing,” she said, looking at Njeri.

“Yes,” replied Njeri, but I did not know you spoke English.”

The lady let out a hearty laugh, once again exposing her toothless gums. She then went on to explain that she was a retired teacher of English, having taught for forty years.

“I was taught the language by owners,” she boasted.

“Just as I learnt your language from its owners,” Cherono remarked proudly. It was the lady’s turn to be astonished, “You mean you do not come from our community yet you speak the language so well?”

Aoko arrived to find the two girls in conversation. She was holding a newspaper. She explained that she had walked all the way to the shopping centre for it, “my great gransma loves reading and as soon as she arrived here this morning she asked for a newspaper.”

Soon afterwards the three girls skipped away leaving the old lady buried in the paper.

26. Njeri wondered what Aoko was doing at home because A. | It was already 10 o’clock

- B. She wanted to play with her
C. They were close friends
D. It was unusual for Aoko to be late
27. During the school holidays, the girls
A. Always met at nine o'clock
B. Loved listening to stories
C. Became close friends
D. Spent the better part of the day together
28. Why did Njeri suggest that "go away and come later"?
A. was she bored
B. She was nervous
C. She was impatient
D. She was worried
29. Which of the following statements best explains why Cherono greeted the old lady in Aoko's mother tongue?
A. She knew the old lady did not know English.
B. She assumed the old lady was from Aoko's community
C. She knew the old lady could understand the language.
D. She wanted to surprise the old lady by speaking her language
30. When Njeri did not understand what the old lady was saying, she must have left
A. Embarrassed
B. Annoyed
C. Frustrated
D. Rejected
31. Which of the following is not a possible explanation why Cherono was curious about the old lady?
A. The old lady was about a hundred years old
B. She had never seen the old lady before
C. The old lady had toothless gums
D. She had learnt the old lady's language
32. Njeri was reluctant to 'go out and chat with the old lady because
A. Only Cherono could understand the old lady's language
B. She did not enjoy stories in another languages
C. She thought the stories would not be in English language
D. The old lady was not from her community
33. The phrase "buried in the paper" as used in the passage means
A. Covered with the paper
B. Reading the paper keenly
C. Looking at the paper
D. The old lady was dead
34. The expression "taken aback" as used in the passage means
A. Shocked
B. Surprised
C. Frightened
D. Excited
35. Why do you think the old lady "let out a hearty laugh"?
A. SHE WAS AMUSED by the girls' ignorance
B. She wanted to surprise the girls
C. She wanted to show off that she knew English
D. She was proud about her community
36. The old lady was 'astonished' because Cherono
A. Was not from her community
B. Had been taught her languages
C. Was a good interpreter
D. Could speak her language fluently
37. Which of the following statements is not true about Aoko?
A. She was shocked to find her friends with her great grandmother
B. She had been away for over thirty minutes
C. She was an obedient girl
D. She loved being with her friends
38. Which of the following sayings can best apply to this passage
A. A stitch in time saves nine
B. Do not judge a book by a cover
C. Experience is the best teacher
D. Better late than never

Read the passage below and then answer questions 39 to 50

One of the most amazing things about the discovery of a 2,000 year old cemetery in the Bahariyah Oasis in Egypt was that no one was looking for it. No one even knew it existed. It had been completely buried by sand.

In 1996, a donkey belonging to a guard peered into a hole, he saw something shining brightly. He reported the discovery to Egyptian archeologists right way.

However, the archaeologists did not begun serious digging immediately. They did not have the workers or the money. So they made a quick survey of the site, and then covered everything up again. They wanted to hide it from thieves and protect it from exposure to the sun and weather. Finally, in 1999, they had enough money to begin exploring the site.

On their very first day of work, after digging only several feet into the sand, they are mostly found a lot of mummies are died bodies that have been preserved for a long time. They are mostly found in Egypt. One of them had an especially beautiful mask. It was not a pharaoh's mummy. Though it turned out that none of the tombs in the cemetery belonged to royalty. Most of the people buried here came from families that grew rich by trading in wine.

The most spectacular of these mummies have masks made of the plaster covered with a layer of gold. Many are in wonderful conditions. And because grave robbers never found these tombs everything that was buried with them is still there. Most of the mummies have been left where the public can take a look at them.

Two mummies were found lying side by side and were probably a husband and wife. His mask and chest plate were decorated with religious figures. Her head was turned in the direction, indicating that the husband had died first.

Two other mummies are of children. Archaeologists think they were brother and sisters because they were found together. The boy was probably about five years old. His mask with its painted eyes and features are so real-he almost seems alive!

Did archaeologists find treasures in these tombs? It depends on what you mean by "treasures". They have not found any solid gold, but they have discovered all sorts of objects. The people buried in the cemetery may have thought some of these items would be useful in the afterlife. Or some may have been intended as gift to the gods. For example, archaeologists have unearthed small statues of various gods. They have found many pieces of jewelry –necklaces, bracelets and anklets-made of copper, glass, ivory and semi-precious stones

They have also discovered many pottery pieces used for storing, cooking or serving food. There were some bronze Greek and roman coins too. And in the children's tombs, they found toys-carved animals for the children to play with in the afterlife.

Archaeologists will be able to learn more about these people and their way of life by further studies their mummies that the things buried with them. And so many mummies were buried in the valley of golden mummies that excavation and learning will continue at the site for years to come.

(Adapted from secrets of the past by world Book, Inc. 2002)

39. The discovery of 2000 year-old cemetery In Bahariyah was
- Very sudden
 - Really surprising
 - Quite accidental
 - Extremely important
40. Who actually discovered the cemetery?
- The guard
 - The donkey
 - The archeologists
 - The Egyptians
41. What can we tell about the archaeologists from the information in the third paragraph
- They did not do things in hurry
 - They had a lot of digging to do
 - They received reports from guards
 - They did not have much money
42. Which of the following statements is not true according to the passage?
- Robbers can interfere with the mummies
 - Thieves had also discovered the cemetery
 - Exposure to the weather can affect the mummies
 - There was enough sand to cover the cemetery
43. The first day of digging can be described as
- Very stressful
 - Quite amazing
 - Very successful
 - Quite interesting
44. “None of the tombs in the cemetery belonged to royalty” means that
- The royal family did not own that cemetery
 - Members of the royal family were not buried there
 - It was not good enough for kings and queens
 - You do not bury such important people anywhere
45. What evidence is there that the people buried there rich
- They traded in wine
 - They were well-preserved
 - Their bodies were beautifully decorated
 - Their masks are covered with a layer of gold
46. What can we assume about the culture of the people buried in this cemetery
- Members of the same family were buried together
 - The people were buried side by side
 - The woman was supposed to face her husbands
 - They used masks in their religious ceremonies
47. According to the passage the word “treasures” means
- Different things to different peoples
 - Is a important word in the passage
 - refers to all sorts of objects
 - refers to items found in the tombs
48. It is obvious that the people in the community believed
- they would meet some gods later
 - the gods expected some gifts
 - there was life after death
 - they needed some items after dying
49. the word unearthed means
- removed
 - discover
 - exposed
 - recovered
50. which of the following would be the best title for the passage
- the unusual discovery
 - the mummies of Bahariyah
 - the wonders of Ancient Egypt
 - the work of Archaeologists

